



Demonstrate climbing skills at a basic level

D2.TTO.CL4.05

Assessor Manual



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William
Angliss
Institute

Specialist centre
for foods, tourism
& hospitality

Project Base

William Angliss Institute of TAFE

555 La Trobe Street

Melbourne 3000 Victoria

Telephone: (03) 9606 2111

Facsimile: (03) 9670 1330

Acknowledgements

Project Director: Wayne Crosbie

Project Manager: Jim Irwin

Chief Writer: Alan Hickman

Subject Writer: Alan Hickman

Editor: Jim Irwin

DTP/Production: Daniel Chee, Mai Vu, Cindy Curran

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Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An Introduction for Assessors

Assessment is the process of identifying a participant's current knowledge, skills and attitudes sets against all elements of competency within a unit of competency.

Suggested Assessment Methods

For each unit of competency a number of assessment tools have been identified including:

- Work Projects
- Oral Questions
- Written Questions
- Third Party Statements
- Observation Checklists.

Instructions and Evidence Recording Sheets have been identified in this Assessment Manual for use by Assessors.

Alternative Assessment Methods

Whilst the above mentioned assessment methods are suggested assessment methods, the assessor may use an alternate method of assessment taking into account:

- a) The nature of the unit
- b) The strengths of participants
- c) The number of participants in the class
- d) Time required to complete assessments
- e) Time dedicated to assessment
- f) Equipment and resources required.

Alternate assessment methods include:

- Practical demonstrations
- Practical demonstrations in simulated work conditions
- Problem solving
- Portfolios of evidence
- Critical incident reports
- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Interviews
- Videos
- Visuals/slides/audiotapes

- Case studies
- Log books
- Projects and Role plays
- Group projects
- Recognition of Prior Learning.

Whilst there is no specific instruction or evidence collection documents for all the alternative assessment methods, assessors can record competency in the 'Other' section within the 'Competency Recording Sheet'.

Selection of Assessment Methods

Each assessor will determine the combination of Assessment Methods to be used to determine Competency for each Competency Unit on a student by student basis.

'Sufficient' evidence to support the 'Pass Competent'/'Not Yet Competent' decision must be captured.

In practice this means a minimum of 2 – 3 Assessment Methods for each candidate for each Competency Element is suggested.

At least one method should provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence.

The following assessment methods deemed to provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence include:

- Practical Work Projects
- Third Party Statement
- Observation Checklist.

Assessing Competency

Competency based assessment does not award grades, but simply identifies if the participant has the knowledge, skills and attitudes to undertake the required task to the specified standard.

Therefore, when assessing competency, an assessor has two possible results that can be awarded:

- 'Pass Competent' (PC)
- 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

Pass Competent (PC)

If the participant is able to successfully answer or demonstrate what is required, to the expected standards of the performance criteria, they will be deemed as 'Pass Competent' (PC).

The assessor will award a 'Pass Competent' (PC) if they feel the participant has the necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes in all assessment tasks for a unit.

Not Yet Competent' (NYC)

If the participant is unable to answer or demonstrate competency to the desired standard, they will be deemed to be 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

This does not mean the participant will need to complete all the assessment tasks again. The focus will be on the specific assessment tasks that were not performed to the expected standards.

The participant may be required to:

- a) Undertake further training or instruction
- b) Undertake the assessment task again until they are deemed to be 'Pass Competent'.

Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System

The 'Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System', also known as the 'RQFSRS' is the overriding educational framework for the ASEAN region.

The purpose of this framework is to provide:

- A standardised teaching and assessment framework
- Mutual recognition of participant achievement across the ASEAN region. This includes achievement in individual Units of Competency or qualifications as a whole.

The role of the 'RQFSRS' is to provide, ensure and maintain 'quality assurance' across all countries and educational providers across the ASEAN region.

Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)

Recognition of Prior Learning is the process that gives current industry professionals who do not have a formal qualification, the opportunity to benchmark their extensive skills and experience against the standards set out in each unit of competency/subject.

This process is a learning and assessment pathway which encompasses:

- Recognition of Current Competencies (RCC)
- Skills auditing
- Gap analysis and training
- Credit transfer.

Code of Practice for Assessors

This Code of Practice provides:

- Assessors with direction on the standard of practice expected of them
- Candidates with assurance of the standards of practice expected of assessors
- Employers with assurance of the standards maintained in the conduct of assessment.

The Code detailed below is based on the International Code of Ethics and Practice (The National Council for Measurement in Education [NCME]):

- The differing needs and requirements of the person being assessed, the local enterprise and/or industry are identified and handled with sensitivity
- Potential forms of conflict of interest in the assessment process and/or outcomes are identified and appropriate referrals are made, if necessary
- All forms of harassment are avoided throughout the planning, conducting, reviewing and reporting of the assessment outcomes

- The rights of the candidate are protected during and after the assessment
- Personal and interpersonal factors that are not relevant to the assessment of competency must not influence the assessment outcomes
- The candidate is made aware of rights and process of appeal
- Evidence that is gathered during the assessment is verified for validity, reliability, authenticity, sufficiency and currency
- Assessment decisions are based on available evidence that can be produced and verified by another assessor
- Assessments are conducted within the boundaries of the assessment system policies and procedures
- Formal agreement is obtained from both the candidate and the assessor that the assessment was carried out in accordance with agreed procedures
- The candidate is informed of all assessment reporting processes prior to the assessment
- The candidate is informed of all known potential consequences of decisions arising from an assessment, prior to the assessment
- Confidentiality is maintained regarding assessment results
- The assessment results are used consistently with the purposes explained to the candidate
- Opportunities are created for technical assistance in planning, conducting and reviewing assessment procedures and outcomes.

Instructions and Checklist for Assessors

Instructions

General instructions for the assessment:

- Assessment should be conducted at a scheduled time that has been notified to the candidate
- Facilitators must ensure participants are made aware of the need to complete assessments and attend assessment sessions
- If a participant is unable to attend a scheduled session, they must make arrangements with the Assessor to undertake the assessment at an alternative time
- At the end of the assessment the Assessor must give feedback and advise the participant on their PC/NYC status
- Complete the relevant documentation and submit to the appropriate department.

Preparation

- Gain familiarity with the Unit of Competency, Elements of Competency and the Performance Criteria expected
- Study details assessment documentation and requirements
- Brief candidate regarding all assessment criteria and requirements.

Briefing Checklist

- Begin the assessment by implementing the following checklist and then invite the candidate to proceed with assessment.

Checklist for Assessors

Prior to the assessment I have:	Tick (✓)	Remarks
Ensured the candidate is informed about the venue and schedule of assessment.		
Received current copies of the performance criteria to be assessed, assessment plan, evidence gathering plan, assessment checklist, appeal form and the company's standard operating procedures (SOP).		
Reviewed the performance criteria and evidence plan to ensure I clearly understood the instructions and the requirements of the assessment process.		
Identified and accommodated any special needs of the candidate.		
Checked the set-up and resources for the assessment.		
During the assessment I have:		
Introduced myself and confirmed identities of candidates.		
Put candidates at ease by being friendly and helpful.		
Explained to candidates the purpose, context and benefits of the assessment.		
Ensured candidates understood the assessment process and all attendant procedures.		
Provided candidates with an overview of performance criteria to be assessed.		
Explained the results reporting procedure.		
Encouraged candidates to seek clarifications if in doubt.		
Asked candidates for feedback on the assessment.		
Explained legal, safety and ethical issues, if applicable.		
After the assessment I have:		
Ensured candidate is given constructive feedback.		
Completed and signed the assessment record.		
Thanked candidate for participating in the assessment.		

Instructions for Recording Competency

Specifications for Recording Competency

The following specifications apply to the preparation of Evidence Gathering Plans:

- A Competency Recording Sheet must be prepared for each candidate to ensure and demonstrate all Performance Criteria and Competency Elements are appropriately assessed. This Sheet indicates how the Assessor will gather evidence during their assessment of each candidate
- This Competency Recording Sheet is located at the end of the Assessment Plan
- It is the overriding document to record competency
- The Assessor may vary the Competency Recording Sheet to accommodate practical and individual candidate and/or workplace needs
- Assessor must place a tick (✓) in the 'Assessment Method' columns to identify the methods of assessment to be used for each candidate
- Multiple Competency Elements/Performance Criteria may be assessed at the one time, where appropriate
- The assessor and participant should sign and date the Competency Recording Sheet, when all forms of evidence and assessment have been completed
- The assessor may provide and feedback or clarify questions which the participant may have in regards to the assessment grade or findings
- All documents used to capture evidence must be retained, and attached to the Competency Recording Sheet for each candidate for each Competency Unit.

Instructions for Different Assessment Methods

Specifications for Work Project Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of work projects.

The work projects identified in the Training Manuals involve a range of tasks, to be performed at the discretion of the Assessor.

Work project tasks can be completed through any form of assessment as identified in the Trainer and Trainee Manuals and stated at the start of this section.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Review the Work Projects at the end of each 'Element of Competency' in the Trainee Manual to ensure you understand the content and what is expected
- Prepare sufficient resources for the completion of work activities including:
 - Time – whether in scheduled delivery hours or suggested time participants to spend outside of class hours
 - Resources – this may involve technical equipment, computer, internet access, stationery and other supplementary materials and documents
- Prepare assessment location (if done in class) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Work Projects assessment to candidate, at the start of each Element of Competency. This ensures that participants are aware of what is expected and can collate information as delivery takes place

- Assessors can use the following phrase as a guide (where an 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
 "At the end of each Element of Competency there are Work Projects which must be completed. These projects require different tasks that must be completed.
 These work projects are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X:
- You are required to complete these activities:
 - Using the 'X' method of assessment*
 - At 'X' location*
 - You will have 'X time period' for this assessment*
 - You are required to compile information in a format that you feel is appropriate to the assessment
 - Do you have any questions about this assessment?"
- Commence Work Project assessment:
 - The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
 - Participants complete work projects in the most appropriate format
 - Participants must submit Work Project evidence to the assessor before the scheduled due date
- Assessor must assess the participant's evidence against the competency standards specified in each Element of Competency and their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has provided evidence to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Oral Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of oral questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines.

- Prepare Assessment Record for Oral Questioning. One record for each candidate:
 - Enter Student name
 - Enter Assessor name
 - Enter Location
- Familiarise self with Questions to be asked
- Prepare assessment location (table and chairs) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Oral Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
"These oral questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability and I will record whether or not you have answered correctly.

We have 60 minutes for this assessment.

- I will give you feedback at the end of the assessment
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- Commence Oral Questioning assessment:
 - Complete Assessment Record for the Oral Questioning by:
 - a) Ticking PC or NYC, as appropriate
 - b) Entering ‘Remarks’ as required
 - c) Completing Oral Questioning within 60 minutes
- Complete Oral Questioning and provide feedback to candidate
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Written Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of written questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Familiarise self with Questions and Answers provided
- Print and distribute copies of ‘Written Questions’ for participants. Ideally this should take place with adequate time for participants to answer all questions before the expected due date
- Explain Written Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a ‘X’ is identified, please input appropriate information):

“These written questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability.

You may refer to your subject materials, however where possible try to utilise your existing knowledge when answering questions.

Where you are unsure of questions, please ask the Assessor for further instruction. This may be answering the question orally or asking the assessor to redefine the question.

We have X time for this assessment:

- The due date for completion of this assessment is X
- On this date you must forward the completed questions to the assessor by X time on the date of X
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
- Participants may record written answers (where possible)
- Participants must submit the written answers to the assessor before the scheduled due date

- Assessor must assess the participant's written answers against the model answers provided as a guide, or their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has answered the questions to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Observation Checklist

These specifications apply to the use of the Observation Checklist in determining competency for candidates.

Only an approved assessor is authorised to complete the Observation Checklist.

The assessor is required to observe the participant, ideally in a simulated environment or their practical workplace setting and record their performance (or otherwise) of the competencies listed on the Observation Checklist for the Competency Unit.

To complete the Observation Checklist the Assessor must:

- Insert name of candidate
- Insert assessor name
- Insert identify of location where observations are being undertaken
- Insert date/s of observations – may be single date or multiple dates
- Place a tick in either the 'Yes' or 'No' box for each listed Performance Criteria to indicate the candidate has demonstrated/not demonstrated that skill
- Provide written (and verbal) feedback to candidate – as/if appropriate
- Sign and date the form
- Present form to candidate for them to sign and date
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Observation Checklist.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the participant.

Specifications for Third Party Statement

These specifications relate to the use of a relevant workplace person to assist in determining competency for candidates.

The Third Party Statement is to be supplied by the assessor to a person in the workplace who supervises and/or works closely with the participant.

This may be their Supervisor, the venue manager, the Department Manager or similar.

The Third Party Statement asks the Supervisor to record what they believe to be the competencies of the participant based on their workplace experience of the participant. This experience may be gained through observation of their workplace performance, feedback from others, inspection of candidate's work etc.

A meeting must take place between the Assessor and the Third Party to explain and demonstrate the use of the Third Party Statement.

To complete the Third Party Verification Statement the Assessor must:

- Insert candidate name
- Insert name and contact details of the Third Party
- Tick the box to indicate the relationship of the Third Party to the candidate
- Present the partially completed form to the Third Party for them to finalise
- Collect the completed form from the Third Party
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Third Party Statement.

The Third Party must:

- Record their belief regarding candidate ability/competency as either:
 - Pass Competent = Yes
 - Not Yet Competent = No
 - Unsure about whether candidate is competent or not = Not Sure
- Meet briefly with the assessor to discuss and/or clarify the form.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the candidate.

A separate Third Party Statement is required for each Competency Unit undertaken by the candidate.

Competency standard

UNIT TITLE: DEMONSTRATE CLIMBING SKILLS AT A BASIC LEVEL		NOMINAL HOURS: 120
UNIT NUMBER: D2.TTO.CL4.05		
UNIT DESCRIPTOR: This unit deals with skills and knowledge required to apply basic climbing skills in a limited range of tour situations to lead members of a climbing party.		
ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA		UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE
Element 1: Select a route 1.1 <i>Identify suitable access to and egress from the climbing site</i> 1.2 <i>Describe the identified climbing route to the climbing party</i> 1.3 <i>Assess the climbing abilities of the members of the climbing party</i> 1.4 <i>Evaluate climb features that will impact on the climb</i> 1.5 <i>Evaluate environmental factors that may impact on the climb</i> 1.6 <i>Identify and communicate climb hazards to members of the climbing party</i> 1.7 <i>Communicate safety procedures to the climbing party</i>		Unit Variables The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment. This unit applies to organisations that are involved in demonstrating and leading tours using basic climbing skills in a limited range of tour situations, within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include: 1. Travel Agencies 2. Tour Operation <i>Identify suitable access to and egress from the climbing site</i> may be related to: • Safe positioning of the climbing party • The environmental conditions that apply • Presence and number of other climbers • Security of vehicles and equipment • Compliance with local requirements.

Element 2: Select and use climbing equipment 2.1 Select <i>equipment</i> appropriate to the climb 2.2 Check the safety and operation of selected climb equipment 2.3 Adhere to <i>industry best practice</i> when attaching rope to climber harness 2.4 Use equipment in a way that minimises damage to the environment and others 2.5 Follow manufacturer's instructions in the use of climbing equipment 2.6 Demonstrate <i>rope handling ability</i>	<i>Describe the identified climbing route will include:</i> • Written and diagrammatic representation • Verbal description • Use of video tape. <i>Climbing abilities of the members of the climbing party may be related to:</i> • Strength • Stamina • Fatigue • Flexibility • Body weight • Balance • Body perception • Mental perceptions • Pre-climb warm-up activities and exercises.
Element 3: Demonstrate climbing techniques 3.1 Identify and evaluate the main climb features of the climb prior to ascent and during the climb 3.2 Plan and communicate <i>sequence of movements and evaluate potential holds</i> 3.3 Apply appropriate <i>climbing techniques</i> for features are present 3.4 Move from point to point 3.5 Identify and apply <i>rest breaks and locations</i> 3.6 <i>Apply correct techniques in the event of a fall</i> 3.7 Maintain communication with belayed throughout the climb	<i>Climb features should include natural and artificial features and may include:</i> • Arêtes • Chimneys • Corners • Cracks • Edges • Flakes • Jugs

3.8 *Apply safety procedures during the climb*

- Overhangs
- Pinnacles
- Pockets
- Protrusions
- Roofs
- Scoops or slab.

Environmental factors should relate to:

- Length of climb
- Time of day
- Weather
- Pressure from nearby climbers
- Impact on flora and fauna.

Climb hazards may include:

- Loose debris/rocks
- Sharp edges
- Nesting birds
- Other climbers
- Spectators.

Safety procedures may include:

- Need to comply with leader instructions
- Procedures in the event of an emergency or fall
- Effective communication techniques during the climb, including climbing terminology, climbing calls, whistles and specific negotiated systems such as hand signals.

	<i>Equipment</i> may include: • Harnesses • Helmets • Boots • Ropes • Tapes • Karabiners • Belay devices • Rope protectors • Slings. <i>Industry best practice</i> may include: • Knots used • Testing of knots • Comfort of climber • Freedom of movement • Correct harness size • Secure fit buckle • Correct adjustment to suit individual climber • Matching harness style to climb and climber. <i>Rope handling ability</i> may include: • Top belaying • Bottom belaying • Out of system belaying.
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	<i>Sequence of movements and evaluate potential holds may relate to:</i> • Demonstrated abilities of climbers • Emerging conditions • Time factors • Safety • Degree of difficulty. <i>Climbing techniques may include:</i> • Bridging • Dynamic movement, including dead pointing • Heel hooks • Jamming • Lay backing • Layaways • Side pulls • Mantle-shelving • Pinch grips • Smearing • Underclings.
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	<i>Rest breaks and locations</i> may include: • Requests from members of the climbing party • Physical and mental condition of members of the climbing party • Suitable locations • Emerging conditions • Time factors • Safety. <i>Apply correct techniques in the event of a fall</i> may include: • Preserving the safety of uninjured climbers • Re-assuring other climbers • Applying basic first aid procedures • Contacting emergency services • Revising the planned climb to accommodate the injuries that have been sustained. <i>Apply safety procedures during the climb</i> may include: • Monitoring the progress and skill levels of members of the climbing party • Correcting incorrect actions of the members of the climbing party • Checking equipment and connections • Revising initial plans • Monitoring changing conditions • Advising members of the climbing party in relation to hazards.
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Assessment Guide

The following skills and knowledge must be assessed as part of this unit:

- Enterprise policies and procedures in regard to preparing and conducting climbs
- Knowledge of climbing equipment and terminology
- Principles of risk management
- Ability to use basic first aid techniques
- Ability to demonstrate practical climbing skills
- Knowledge of the applicable industry climbing standards and codes of practice relevant to the host country
- Principles of minimum impact climbing techniques in the natural environment.

Linkages To Other Units

- Perform basic first aid procedures
- Manage operational risk
- Lead tour groups in a responsible manner
- Allocate tour resources
- Implement occupational health and safety procedures
- Prepare and deliver training sessions.

Critical Aspects of Assessment

Evidence of the following is essential:

- Understanding of host enterprise policies and procedures relating to climbing activities and the safety of customers
- Demonstrated ability to interpret and apply the industry climbing standards and codes of practice relevant to the host country

	• Demonstrated ability to lead a nominated group of climbers on a designated natural climb, assessing the climbers prior to the climb, selecting and describing a suitable route, selecting and using appropriate equipment for the climb and for individual members of the climbing party and applying appropriate climbing and monitoring techniques to safely climb the selected route • Demonstrated ability to lead a nominated group of climbers on a designated artificial climb, assessing the climbers prior to the climb, selecting and describing a suitable route, selecting and using appropriate equipment for the climb and for individual members of the climbing party and applying appropriate climbing and monitoring techniques to safely climb the selected route. Context of Assessment This unit may be assessed on or off the job: • Assessment should include practical demonstration either in the workplace or through a simulation activity, supported by a range of methods to assess underpinning knowledge • Assessment must relate to the individual's work area or area of responsibility • Assessment of climbing techniques. Resource Implications Training and assessment must include use of a real climbing surface either natural or artificial, real equipment and real people; and access to workplace standards, procedures, policies, guidelines, tools and equipment. Assessment Methods The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit: • Observation of practical candidate performance • Oral and written questions • Third party reports completed by a supervisor • Project and assignment work.
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	Key Competencies in this Unit <i>Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively</i> <i>Level 2 = competence to manage tasks</i> <i>Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating</i>		
	Key Competencies	Level	Examples
	Collecting, organising and analysing information	2	Determine the capabilities of climbers
	Communicating ideas and information	2	Convey route and safety instructions
	Planning and organising activities	3	Organise the climbing party
	Working with others and in teams	3	Assist climbers during the climb
	Using mathematical ideas and techniques	1	Calculate times for a climb
	Solving problems	2	Revise climb route during the climb on the basis of hazards and climber abilities
	Using technology	2	Use climbing equipment

Oral questions

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Demonstrate climbing skills at a basic level D2.TTO.CL4.05
Instructions	1. Ask student questions from the attached list to confirm knowledge, as necessary 2. Place tick in boxes to reflect student achievement (Pass Competent 'PC' or Not Yet Competent 'NYC') 3. Write short-form student answer in the space provided for each question.

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
1. Who is and is not included in the climbing party?	☐	☐
2. What factors would you consider when identifying safe access and egress to a climb site?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
3. What options are available for grading climb sites?	☐	☐
4. What issues might you need to consider with a new climb site?	☐	☐
5. Explain Duty of Care.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
6. In what ways can you assess the climbing ability of participants?	☐	☐
7. Explain the two ways in which climbing features are classified.	☐	☐
8. Explain what types of artificial features are available.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
9. Explain the ways in which weather can impact a climb.	☐	☐
10. What factors need to be considered when there are other climbers at a climb site?	☐	☐
11. Explain how you could identify climb hazards.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
12. How would you communicate any climb hazards identified?	☐	☐
13. Explain basic safety procedures to be communicated to a climb group.	☐	☐
14. Explain the alphabet approach.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
15. Explain why tour companies generally do not allow people to provide their own climbing equipment.	☐	☐
16. Explain the following pieces of equipment; • Belay device • Rope protector • Sling	☐	☐
17. What are standard procedures regarding the safety and operation of selected climb equipment?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
18. What formal basis may be used to replace gear to ensure safety?	☐	☐
19. Explain the following knots and their use • Bowline • Figure 8 knot on the bight • Stopper knot • Monkey fist • Münter hitch • Prusik knot • Water knot	☐	☐
20. Explain key points for attaching a harness.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
21. Identify some necessary actions to minimise environmental impact in climb areas.	☐	☐
22. Based on class notes and discussion identify recommended regular bolting practises.	☐	☐
23. Identify generic advice in regard to the use of climbing equipment for safety and warranty and duty of care.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
24. Identify factors that would cause you to dispose of ropes, including manufacturer's instructions.	☐	☐
25. When handling ropes what needs to be taken into consideration for their use shelf life and safety?	☐	☐
26. Explain belaying and the various uses of the term.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
27. Explain the following terms in relation to natural features; • Arête • Chimney • Corner • Cracks • Edges • Flakes NB (assessor may choose a modified or extended range of terms)	☐	☐
28. Explain the following terms in relation to geometric artificial features; • Incuts • Ledges • Pinches • Pockets • Roof jugs • Slopers NB (assessor may choose a modified or extended range of terms)	☐	☐
29. Explain some factors involved when planning the sequence of movement for a climb and evaluating potential hand holds.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
30. Explain some activities involved when planning the sequence of movement for a climb and evaluating potential hand holds.	☐	☐
31. Explain the following climbing techniques • Bridging • Dynamic movement • Dead points • Heel hooks • Jamming (hand and foot) NB (assessor may choose a modified or extended range of terms)	☐	☐
32. Explain the following climbing • Lay backing • Layaways/sidepulls • Mantle-shelving • Pinch grips • Smearing • Undercling NB (assessor may choose a modified or extended range of terms)	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
33. Identify some standard climb leader considerations when climbers are climbing.	☐	☐
34. What instructions might a climb leader give to encourage a climber regarding advice or techniques?	☐	☐
35. Identify important basic understandings regarding timing of rest breaks	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
36. What should you consider when determining location of rest breaks?	☐	☐
37. Identify actions the lead climber may take if responding to a fall.	☐	☐
38. What may be involved if actions require contacting emergency services?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
39. Explain the variation in context for climbing calls.	☐	☐
40. Explain the following verbal climbing calls. (Assessor to choose) • Any of the following: • Belay off • Belay on • Climb on/Climb when ready • Climbing • Off belay • OK • Resting • Rock • Rope/Rope below • Safe • Slack • Take in • Taking in • That's me • Tight • Up rope	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
41. Explain what it means to be 'monitoring climbers'.	☐	☐
42. How might a lead climber help or direct a climber regarding incorrect actions?	☐	☐

Written questions

Demonstrate climbing skills at a basic level – D2.TTO.CL4.05

Student Name: _____

Answer all the following questions and submit to your Trainer.

1. A climb site may refer to what type of locations?

2. What options are available in relation to access and egress from a climb site?(List four)

3. Why are climbs graded?

4. What methods may be used to communicate a climbing route?

5. Why is it necessary to assess the ability of the climbing party?

6. What do you need to be aware of under Duty of Care obligations?

7. List four reasons why you would evaluate climb route features.

8. Explain the following terms;

Arête _____

Chimney _____

Corner _____

Cracks _____

Edges _____

Flakes _____

Jugs _____

Overhangs _____

Pinnacles _____

Pockets _____

Protrusions _____

Roofs _____

Scoops or slabs _____

9. Under what weather conditions may a climb be cancelled or postponed?

10. Why is the time of day taken into account regarding climbs?

11. List four ways you can identify climb hazards.

12. List four examples of climb hazards.

13. List four common risks when rock climbing.

14. Explain the alphabet approach.

15. Explain the design features of climbing shoes.

16. Explain the following pieces of equipment;

Tapes _____

Karabiners _____

Belay devices _____

Slings _____

17. When visually checking gear what would you be alert to?

18. What is the process for dealing with items identified as 'unsafe' or 'unserviceable'?

19. What should be done in relation to knots before use?

20. Identify the following types of knots and their purpose;

Monkey fist _____

Münter hitch _____

Prusik knot _____

Water knot _____

21. Minimal impact on the environment includes not doing certain things regarding behaviour such as....? (List four)

22. What types of bolts are not recommended?

23. Why is it necessary to follow manufacturer's instructions regarding climbing equipment?

24. Identify care instructions relating to helmets.

25. Why should a double-rope system be applied to courses that zigzag?

26. What does a belayer do?

27. List four reasons why you need to identify and evaluate features on a climb route.

28. Communicating features to climbers before a climb starts may take place where?

29. List four factors that need to be taken into account when planning the sequence of movements for a climb and evaluating potential holds.

30. What activities are involved when planning a new climb?

31. Describe the climbing technique 'heel hook'.

32. Describe the climbing technique 'mantle-shelving'.

33. In what way is the climber in charge of the climb?

34. What are 'static movements'?

35. List four factors involved in relation to timing of rest breaks?

36. How are rest locations for a new climb determined?

37. Identify four basic first-aid procedures a climb leader should be able to deal with.

38. When a fall occurs and only minor injuries have been sustained, what action may be required by the Tour leader?

39. List eight verbal calls that may be used by the leader/belayer.

40. What options for communication may be used other than verbal calls?

41. Safety practises include what categories?

42. Identify four checks when checking equipment and connections as part of complying with safety conditions.

Answers to written questions

Demonstrate climbing skills at a basic level – D2.TTO.CL4.05

The following are model answers only – Trainers/Assessors must use discretion when determining whether or not an answer provided by a Student is acceptable or not.

1. A climb site may refer to what type of locations?

- A mountain
- A cliff
- A wall
- A cave.

2. What options are available in relation to access and egress from a climb site? (List four)

Any of the following:

- Walking in and out
- Road travel to the site
- Boat transportation
- Air travel (airplane or helicopter)
- Combination of the above.

3. Why are climbs graded?

- Provide a standardised system for rating all types of climbs
- Give a general indication of the difficulty of a climb
- Enable consistency when describing or promoting a climb
- Allow people to challenge themselves and progress at different levels.

4. What methods may be used to communicate a climbing route?

- Written description
- Diagrammatic representation
- Use of video tape/DVD
- Verbal description.

5. Why is it necessary to assess the ability of the climbing party?

- Discharge 'Duty of Care' obligations
- Decide whether individuals will be allowed to climb or not
- Determine the route to be used at a climbing site
- Gain insight into individuals who may need special attention and help.

6. What do you need to be aware of under Duty of Care obligations?

- The law *assumes* this obligation exists – the customer/climber does not have to prove it
- Climbers can sue for negligence if it can be proved the required Duty of Care requirements were not adequately discharged
- Climbers may be awarded damages if their legal action is successful
- Organisations have established protocols to help climb leaders ensure these obligations have been met – and provide evidence they have
- Tour operators may require climbers to sign a 'Voluntary Assumption of Risk' (a waiver) document – in an attempt to limit their liability if there is an incident.

7. List four reasons why you would evaluate climb route features.

Any of the following:

- Discharge basic Duty of Care obligations
- Identify hazards – see section 1.5
- Match the climb and the challenges it presents to the abilities of the climbers
- Identify rest spots and spaces
- Work out the climbing techniques required/to be used
- Determine clipping stances
- Determine hand and foot holds/placements
- Determine equipment/gear required/to be used
- Assist with planning the pre-climb briefing, demonstrations and/or training sessions.

8. Explain the following terms;**Chimney**

A chimney is a crack in the rock that is large enough to allow a climber to fit inside and climb inside the rock opening

Corner

A corner is essentially the inverse of Arêtes.

Cracks

These are long splits in the rock face.

Edges

These are narrow, sharp rock ledges

Flakes

These are thin pieces of rock detached from the main rock which may provide a good hold.

Jugs

These are big hand holds.

Overhangs

Overhangs are rock protrusions from the face that are less than 90° to the horizontal.

Pinnacles

These are pointed rock formations.

Pockets

Holes in the rock deep enough to get a good finger hold in.

Protrusions

Protrusions are pieces of rock jutting out from the main face.

Roofs

Roofs are steep overhangs.

Scoops or slabs

These are rock protrusions from the face that are greater than 90° to the horizontal.

9. Under what weather conditions may a climb be cancelled or postponed?

- Rain/'too much' rain
- Wind/winds which are 'too high/strong'
- Electrical storms
- Fog/low cloud.

10. Why is the time of day taken into account regarding climbs?

- Determining travel time – to and from the climb site
- Available light – to enable safety and adequate sighting of features
- Expected length/duration of the climb – to ensure:
 - The climb can be completed during suitable daylight hours
 - There is sufficient allowance built-in to allow for delays and problems.

11. List four ways you can identify climb hazards.

Any of the following:

- Look at and inspect the route – which may require:
- mind 'Important note' above
- Factor in personal experience – gained through actually climbing the route
- Speak to others who are at the site at the time and who have already undertaken the climb
- Preview the climb
- Read about the climb.

12. List four examples of climb hazards.

Any of the following:

- Loose debris/rocks
- Loose or soft vegetation underfoot
- Sharp edges
- Nesting birds
- Biting and stinging insects
- Snakes
- Loose pitons or bolts
- Litter/debris
- Trees
- Other climbers
- Spectators.

13. List four common risks when rock climbing.

Any of the following:

- Fall from height
- Student belaying skill level
- Slips and trips
- Entanglement (hair, clothing, jewellery)
- Falling objects (including rocks)
- Excessive speed while descending.

14. Explain the alphabet approach.

- A = Anchors - secure and suitable to application
- B = Buckles - locked as per manufacturers recommendations
- C = Connector - locked, secured and orientated
- D = Devices - threaded correctly and secured
- E = Enterprise-specific procedures including; end or rope knots, friction hitches, belayer ready, helmet chin strap, clothing, jewellery and hair secured.
- F = Friend - cross check.

15. Explain the design features of climbing shoes.

They are designed to:

- Hug the foot firmly to prevent foot slippage within the shoe
- Provide a sticky bottom/sole which enhances grip and friction on the climbing surface
- Match the type of climb expected – in that their design varies to suit the individualised need of climbing a flat face or a face with lots of cracks.

16. Explain the following pieces of equipment;**Tapes**

Tape may be supplied to climbers for them to wrap around their hands and/or over their fingers to:

- Protect from abrasions and tendon injury
- Give better purchase on hand and finger holds.

Karabiners

These are metal connectors/loops with spring-loaded gates used to connect ropes and equipment.

They are available in different shapes for different uses.

Karabiners (also called Carabiners) may be:

- Lockable/locking – meaning they can be locked so they do not come open by mistake or accident and are used for critical connections/anchor points
- Non-locking/non-lockable.

Belay devices

A belay device is a piece of equipment used by the climber to assist with control during belaying by providing an effective braking mechanism.

Different styles are available and they are essential for climber safety in that they are vital to help prevent falls.

Slings

A sling is a loop of webbing.

They are available in multiple sizes, strengths and types and may be:

- Slung over a climb feature (such as a protrusion) to provide support, balance or purchase
- Used for anchor point set-ups.

17. When visually checking gear what would you be alert to?

- Condition of laces of shoes
- Damage to buckles on harnesses
- Wear on straps on helmets
- Grooves in karabiners
 - Operating each item to ensure it functions as expected
 - Feeling and inspecting ropes as they are coiled.

18. What is the process for dealing with items identified as 'unsafe' or 'unserviceable'?

- Tagging the item as 'Out Of Service'
- Immediately removing the item from user
- Making arrangements for repair or replacement .

19. What should be done in relation to knots before use?

- Double-check all knots which are tied
- Test all knots after they are tied and before they are used – that is, before they are used to ‘take weight’.

20. Identify the following types of knots and their purpose.

- Monkey fist – tied at the end of a rope so as to give weight to the rope to assist with throwing a rope
- Münter hitch – used for belaying
- Prusik knot – can be used for connecting items/objects to a rope, or fixing one rope another
- Water knot – effective for joining two ropes together.

21. Minimal impact on the environment includes not doing certain things regarding behaviour such as....? (List four)

Any of the following:

- Not scaring animals
- Not disturbing nests found on a climb
- Not removing eggs from nests
- Not picking flowers
- Not clearing moss and similar from surfaces.

22. What types of bolts are not recommended?

- No hammered in carrots, no pitons, and no galvanised bolts;
- Expansion bolts are not preferred due to the corrosive environment; and
- No self-tapping/self-drilling bolts unless manufactured for climbing – and meeting European Standards.”

23. Why is it necessary to follow manufacturer’s instructions regarding climbing equipment?

- Optimise likelihood of complying with Duty of Care obligations
- Avoid accidents and incidents
- Maximise the useable life of items.

24. Identify care instructions relating to helmets.

- Avoid high temperatures (above 50°C), and strong light
- Some models come with a protective storage bag.
- Squashing your helmet into your pack and then sitting on it is a guaranteed way to damage it
- Some commonly available solvents and chemicals can damage the shell material of your helmet.

25. Why should a double-rope system be applied to courses that zigzag?

This provides an extra level of safety, and reduces the amount of rope drag climbers will experience.

26. What does a belayer do?

The person who is securing the climber; they secure the climber by controlling the rope and using the belay device to:

- Clamp the rope in the event of a fall
- Take up slack
- Feed out extra line.

27. List four reasons why you need to identify and evaluate features on a climb route.

Any of the following:

- Discharge basic Duty of Care obligations
- Identify hazards on the climb
- Match the climb and the challenges it presents to the abilities of the climbers
- Identify rest spots and spaces
- Work out the climbing techniques required/to be used
- Determine clipping stances
- Determine hand and foot holds/placements
- Determine equipment/gear required/to be used
- Assist with planning the pre-climb briefing, demonstrations and/or training sessions.

28. Communicating features to climbers before a climb starts may take place where?

- In a briefing room before the group departs the climb office
- At the foot of a climb
- At the top of a descent, as part of the pre-climb briefing.

29. List four factors that need to be taken into account when planning the sequence of movements for a climb and evaluating potential holds.

- Demonstrated abilities of climbers
- Emerging conditions
- Time factors
- Safety (which is always the paramount concern and a non-negotiable factor)
- Degree of difficulty.

30. What activities are involved when planning a new climb?

Where the climb is a new one:

- The climb leader should visit the site in advance to reconnoitre the climb and gather necessary information to allow an informed plan to be prepared
- The climb leader should aim to actually climb the route to gain first-hand experience – commonly in company with another team member to assist with capturing information for later analysis and use.

31. Describe the climbing technique ‘heel hook’.

This technique is used to gain access to hand holds which would be otherwise unattainable.

The heel hook involves placing the heel of one foot securely on a foot hold and using that point of contact to pivot (‘hook’) the body so the arm can extend and reach the desired hand hold.

32. Describe the climbing technique ‘mantle-shelving’.

A standard/basic climbing technique where the climber pushes themselves (rather than pulling themselves) up from a ledge (or ‘mantle’) without using any other hold.

This move/technique is also called ‘a mantle’ or ‘mantling’.

33. In what way is the climber in charge of the climb?

In that they can request:

- More rope
- Slack is taken in
- A rest break.

34. What are ‘static movements’?

Where each move is completed before the next move is considered or started following the basic rule of moving the hands, feet or limbs **then** moving/transferring body weight.

35. List four factors involved in relation to timing of rest breaks.

Any of the following:

- Factor in their level of fitness and strength
- Take their known and/or claimed previous climbing experience into account
- Heed any requests made by climbers
- Assess the mental condition of members of the party
- Bear in mind emerging conditions as these may impact the climb
- Keep in mind time limitations.

36. How are rest locations for a new climb determined?

- Pre-climbing the route – if possible/practical to identify potential rest spots
- Visually inspecting the route – from below/above to determine (for example) suitable ledges.

37. Identify four basic first-aid procedures a climb leader should be able to deal with.

- Applying EAR and CPR
- Stemming bleeding
- Treating bruises, abrasions, fractures and sprains
- Managing possible head and spinal injuries
- Treating shock
- Monitor condition of casualty until professional assistance arrives.

38. When a fall occurs and only minor injuries have been sustained, what action may be required by the Tour leader?

- Altering the climbing route
- Eliminating 'more challenging' obstacles or features
- Avoiding the more complex climbing techniques.

39. List eight verbal calls that may be used by the leader/belayer.

Any of the following:

- Belay off
- Belayer on
- Climb on/Climb when ready
- Climbing
- Off belay
- OK
- Resting
- Rock
- Rope/Rope below
- Safe
- Slack
- Take in
- Taking in
- That's me
- Tight
- Up rope.

40. What options for communication may be used other than verbal calls?

- Two-way radios may be used
- Rope tugs may be used
- Whistles may be used
- A specific negotiated system of hand signals may be used.

41. Safety practises include what categories?

- Monitoring climbers
- Correcting incorrect actions
- Checking equipment and connections
- Revising initial plans
- Monitoring changing conditions
- Advising members of the climbing party.

42. Identify four checks when checking equipment and connections as part of complying with safety conditions.

- Verify knots, fasteners, clips and buckles are secure
 - Make sure buckles are double-backed
 - Ensure all safety/protective gear (for examples: helmets, knee pads) allocated is still being worn
 - Look for frayed rope(s)
 - Replace metal items which have been dropped from a reasonable height onto a rock or concrete bottom
 - Remove dirt and debris
 - Encourage climbers to check/keep an eye on the equipment and connections of other climbers.
-

Observation checklist

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Demonstrate climbing skills at a basic level D2.TTO.CL4.05
Dates of observation	
Instructions	- Over a period of time observe the student completing each of the following tasks: - Select a route - Select and use climbing equipment - Demonstrate climbing techniques - Enter the date on which the tasks were undertaken - Place a tick in the box to show they completed each aspect of the task to the standard expected in the enterprise - Complete the feedback sections of the form, if required.

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 1: Select a route		
Identify suitable access to and egress from the climbing site	☐	☐
Describe the identified climbing route to the climbing party	☐	☐
Assess the climbing abilities of the members of the climbing party	☐	☐
Evaluate climb features that will impact on the climb	☐	☐
Evaluate environmental factors that may impact on the climb	☐	☐
Identify and communicate climb hazards to members of the climbing party	☐	☐
Communicate safety procedures to the climbing party	☐	☐

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 2: Select and use climbing equipment		
Select equipment appropriate to the climb	☐	☐
Check the safety and operation of selected climb equipment	☐	☐
Adhere to industry best practice when attaching rope to climber harness	☐	☐
Use equipment in a way that minimises damage to the environment and others	☐	☐
Follow manufacturer's instructions in the use of climbing equipment	☐	☐
Demonstrate rope handling ability	☐	☐
Element 3: Demonstrate climbing techniques		
Identify and evaluate the main climb features of the climb prior to ascent and during the climb	☐	☐
Plan and communicate sequence of movements and evaluate potential holds	☐	☐
Apply appropriate climbing techniques for features are present	☐	☐
Move from point to point	☐	☐
Identify and apply rest breaks and locations	☐	☐
Apply correct techniques in the event of a fall	☐	☐
Maintain communication with belayed throughout the climb	☐	☐
Apply safety procedures during the climb	☐	☐
Did the student's overall performance meet the standard?	☐	☐

Feedback to student and trainer/assessor**Strengths:****Improvements needed:****General comments:****Candidate signature****Date****Assessor signature****Date**

Third Party Statement

Student name:			
Name of third party:		Contact no:	
Relationship to student:	☐ Employer ☐ Supervisor ☐ Colleague ☐ Other <i>Please specify: _____</i> <i>Please do not complete the form if you are a relative, close friend or have a conflict of interest]</i>		
Unit of competency:	Demonstrate climbing skills at a basic level D2.TTO.CL4.05		
The student is being assessed against industry competency standards and we are seeking your support in the judgement of their competence. Please answer these questions as a record of their performance while working with you. Thank you for your time.			
Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response]</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Element 1: Select a route			
Identified suitable access to and egress from the climbing site	☐	☐	☐
Described the identified climbing route to the climbing party	☐	☐	☐
Assessed the climbing abilities of the members of the climbing party	☐	☐	☐
Evaluated climb features that will impact on the climb	☐	☐	☐
Evaluated environmental factors that may impact on the climb	☐	☐	☐
Identified and communicate climb hazards to members of the climbing party	☐	☐	☐
Communicated safety procedures to the climbing party	☐	☐	☐

Element 2: Select and use climbing equipment			
Selected equipment appropriate to the climb	☐	☐	☐
Checked the safety and operation of selected climb equipment	☐	☐	☐
Adhered to industry best practice when attaching rope to climber harness	☐	☐	☐
Used equipment in a way that minimises damage to the environment and others	☐	☐	☐
Followed manufacturer's instructions in the use of climbing equipment	☐	☐	☐
Demonstrated rope handling ability	☐	☐	☐
Element 3: Demonstrate climbing techniques			
Identified and evaluate the main climb features of the climb prior to ascent and during the climb	☐	☐	☐
Planned and communicate sequence of movements and evaluate potential holds	☐	☐	☐
Applied appropriate climbing techniques for features are present	☐	☐	☐
Moved from point to point	☐	☐	☐
Identified and apply rest breaks and locations	☐	☐	☐
Applied correct techniques in the event of a fall	☐	☐	☐
Maintained communication with belayed throughout the climb	☐	☐	☐
Applied safety procedures during the climb	☐	☐	☐

Comments/feedback from Third Party to Trainer/Assessor:**Third party signature:****Date:****Send to:**

Competency recording sheet

Name of Student		
Name of Assessor/s		
Unit of Competency	Demonstrate climbing skills at a basic level	D2.TTO.CL4.05
Date assessment commenced		
Date assessment finalised		
Assessment decision	Pass Competent / Not Yet Competent (Circle one)	
Follow up action required (Insert additional work and assessment required to achieve competency)		
Comments/observations by assessor/s		

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 1: Select a route						
Identify suitable access to and egress from the climbing site						
Describe the identified climbing route to the climbing party						
Assess the climbing abilities of the members of the climbing party						
Evaluate climb features that will impact on the climb						
Evaluate environmental factors that may impact on the climb						
Identify and communicate climb hazards to members of the climbing party						
Communicate safety procedures to the climbing party						

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 2: Select and use climbing equipment						
Select equipment appropriate to the climb						
Check the safety and operation of selected climb equipment						
Adhere to industry best practice when attaching rope to climber harness						
Use equipment in a way that minimises damage to the environment and others						
Follow manufacturer's instructions in the use of climbing equipment						
Demonstrate rope handling ability						

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 3: Demonstrate climbing techniques						
Identify and evaluate the main climb features of the climb prior to ascent and during the climb						
Plan and communicate sequence of movements and evaluate potential holds						
Apply appropriate climbing techniques for features are present						
Move from point to point						
Identify and apply rest breaks and locations						
Apply correct techniques in the event of a fall						
Maintain communication with belayed throughout the climb						
Apply safety procedures during the climb						
Candidate signature:			Date:			
Assessor signature:			Date:			

